

Chapter 1 (my comments first):

- Could motivate this paper with a splash page ad.
- Motivate this as about “fame” or superstar status.
- Too much detail on the winners, need to focus.
- Do they evaluate the productivity of the animals? Or just the physical traits?
- We need a diagram to explain how premier sire is chosen.
- DONT TALK ABOUT BRAEDALE GOLDWYN
- Why are there purple dots next to the green dots?
 - The network graph makes no sense.
- Need to talk about what degree of relatedness you are considering!
- Dairy genetic pedigrees are usually only three generations.
- Sexed semen is not a thing yet, so dont talk about it.
- Don't use the term beauty.
- Table Event Study needs to have spaces between rows
 - And don't use variable names.
- When you have those fixed effects what are PTAs explaining?
- Event study needs to be for each year.
- **Matt**
 - The period you looked at before genomics before sexed semen and genomics. In that era, they were selected to produce both males and females. Now they've locked out dairy farmers from the process of making bulls.
 - **Now, the name recognition is not as important.**
- **Peter**
 - Is this still relevant?
 - Battle between beauty and yield has been going on forever.
 - Help us get away from obsession about conformation?
 - Is this irrational behavior?
- **Mary**
 - This is really about there are two different markets: one based on profit, one based on shows.
 - Why is this important for us to understand?
 - Dairy production versus niche competition.
 - Why wouldn't a genetic company use pedigree?
 - Difference between World Dairy Expo

Chapter 2 (my comments first):

- Use the term “superstars” not “supersires”
- You need to help people understand what the economics perspective adds to this question.
- Why are firms increasing the number of bulls for sale?
- Can you distinguish between the choice set effect and the competition effect?
- You need to emphasize that genomic selection **should have discovered those alternative lines.**
- Are these costs justified?

- **Matt**
 - Really interesting. Makes sense to me.
 - The bull is proxying the female traits.
 - Not taking into account the intellectual property effects.
 - Gene editing won't do that.
 - Angus association bans cows that have an inbreeding coefficient more than 3%.
- **Mary**
 - Post-selection, if you did a simulation would you automatically choose a group that has higher inbreeding.
 - Defend parallel trends
 - Framed as an externality, so why don't breeders "pay" the costs of their actions. Aren't the benefits outweighing the costs?
- **Peter**
 - Casual use of the term inbreeding? People have been doing it forever.
 - Make a stronger case for why inbreeding is bad.
 - This is all about information asymmetry.

Chapter 3 (my comments first):

- These are semen prices, how does that compare to live bull prices?
- Very good maps! But need a better color scale.
- Age might need to be a discrete variable.

Discussion:

Comments from Matt:

- Make the distinction between the two essays and the beef, talk about the genetic differences between these markets.
- How does what we learn from the first two chapters inform the third chapter?
- Chapter 3: beauty contest?
 - EPDs versus physical traits
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Comments from Mary:

- This could even be a final defense
- Framing: needs to be more tidy
- Chapter 1: so what?
- Chapter 2: not overselling the cost angle
- IO of the

Peter:

- The first two show the integration of pedigree information into cattle pricing.
- It is a network!